

MENA Digital Transformation Index 2026

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Executive Summary

The MENA Digital Transformation Index 2026 provides a comprehensive assessment of digital maturity across 8 key markets in the region: Jordan, UAE, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Morocco, Tunisia, Bahrain, and Oman. The index evaluates digital infrastructure, government digital services, private sector adoption, e-commerce penetration, and fintech innovation. The combined digital economy of MENA is projected to reach \$500 billion by 2030, representing 12% of regional GDP. The UAE and Saudi Arabia lead the index with scores of 89.2 and 84.7 respectively, while Jordan ranks 4th with a score of 71.3, demonstrating strong progress in government digitalization and fintech adoption.

Key Findings

- 1. Government Digital Services:** 78% of government services in Jordan are now available digitally, up from 45% in 2022. The UAE leads with 98% digitalization.
- 2. E-Commerce Growth:** E-commerce transactions in MENA reached \$85 billion in 2025, with a CAGR of 18.2%. Saudi Arabia and UAE account for 60% of the market.
- 3. Fintech Innovation:** The number of fintech startups in MENA grew from 150 in 2020 to over 800 in 2026. Jordan's fintech ecosystem ranks 3rd in the region.
- 4. AI Adoption:** 64% of large enterprises in MENA have implemented at least one AI solution, with the UAE (82%) and Saudi Arabia (74%) leading adoption rates.
- 5. Cloud Infrastructure:** Public cloud spending in MENA reached \$8.2 billion in 2025, with hyperscale providers investing \$3.5 billion in regional data centers.

Jordan Profile

Jordan demonstrates strong performance in digital government transformation (score: 78.4) and fintech innovation (score: 72.1). The Kingdom's digital strategy focuses on three pillars: e-government services, digital skills development, and fostering tech entrepreneurship. Key initiatives include the Jordan Digital Strategy 2023-2027, the National Fintech Strategy, and the King Abdullah II Fund for Development's innovation programs. However, challenges remain in broadband infrastructure in rural areas (penetration: 67% vs 94% urban) and digital skills gap among the workforce.

Strategic Recommendations

For Governments: Accelerate 5G deployment, establish unified digital identity systems, create regulatory sandboxes for emerging technologies, and invest in digital literacy programs.

For Enterprises: Prioritize cloud migration, adopt AI-powered analytics, invest in cybersecurity frameworks, and develop digital transformation roadmaps aligned with international standards.

For Investors: Focus on fintech, healthtech, edtech, and SaaS solutions targeting the MENA market. The Jordanian tech ecosystem offers attractive entry valuations and government incentives.

For Consulting Partners: Position digital transformation services with ISO 27001, ISO 20000, and ITIL frameworks. The demand for digital governance consulting is growing 34% annually in the region.

Methodology

The index is compiled using primary data from official government statistics (Jordan's Ministry of Digital Economy, UAE's TDRA, Saudi's MCIT), secondary data from international organizations (World Bank, ITU, WEF), and proprietary surveys conducted across 2,400 enterprises in the 8 target markets. The scoring model uses 42 indicators across 6 dimensions, weighted by their impact on economic competitiveness and social development. All data was collected between October 2025 and March 2026.